

✓ Project | Build the charity: water Game

Concept

Your Mission

Over 700 million people worldwide lack access to clean water. charity: water is on a mission to change that and they need your help getting the word out.

In this project, you will design, wireframe, and build a working prototype of a web-based game that inspires young people to donate to charity: water. You'll think like a UX designer, a game designer, and a developer, all at once.

This is real work. Put your best foot forward - this belongs in your portfolio!

Step 1: Choose Your Game Idea

Your goal is to decide on a game that would be fun, engaging, and relevant for charity: water's goals. Choose something you'd enjoy working on, and that you would be excited to share in your portfolio later on!

Here are some ideas to get you started (feel free to go with those!) —

- **Water Quest:** A fast-paced, whack-a-mole-style game where players tap charity: water's signature yellow jerry cans to earn points. Include a score counter, feedback messages, milestones, and optional obstacles to make it more engaging.
 - **Water Drop:** In this game, users collect as many falling water drops as possible while avoiding pollutants (bad drops). Users tap to collect drops before they hit the ground. Include a score counter, feedback messages, and penalties for "bad drops" to make it more engaging.
- Don't like these ideas? Brainstorm a game concept, or build on the provided examples.

Step 2: Mock-Up Your Game

Create a visual mock-up of your game using hand-drawing. Your mock-up should show the key features of your game and include [branded logos](#).

For this deliverable, we are looking for **two pages total (No AI for this)**:

- A **Starting Page** that shows how a player begins the game.
- A **Gameplay Page** that shows what the game looks like while it is being played and how it works.

As you design each page, think about what the player sees on screen, such as the title, score, buttons, progress bars, icons, or avatars. Be sure to include all elements, even those users often take for granted, like a 'start' button or a message that tells the player the game has ended.



charity: water

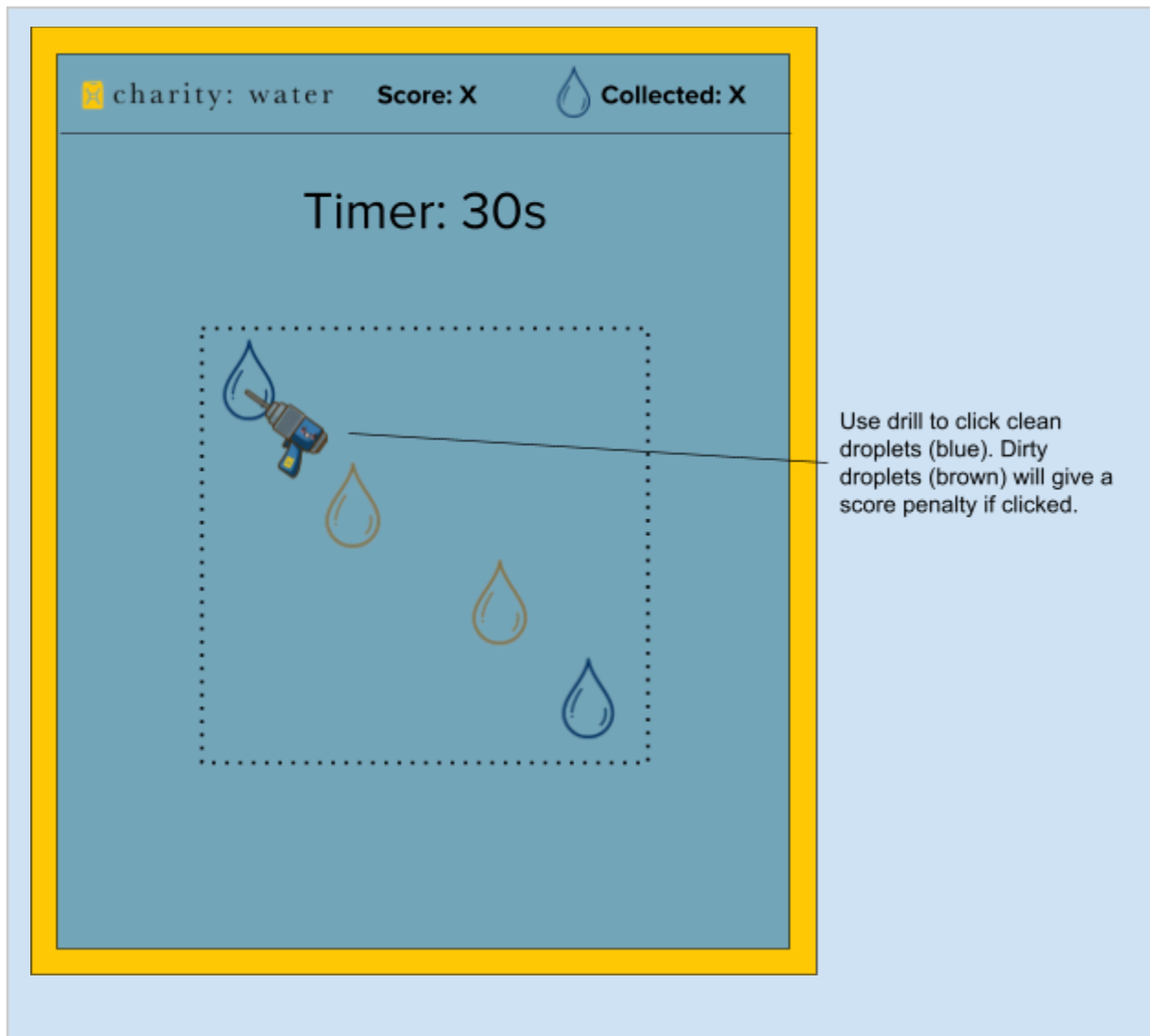
WATER QUEST

Use your drill to tap the water drops
before they disappear!



START GAME

All proceeds go toward water projects!



Step 3: Plan the Game Logic

Using the template provided below, write up a short explanation of how the game logic works. Ask yourself: What actions does the player take? What gets updated—score, timer, achievements? What feedback does the player get (e.g., animations, visual cues, milestone unlocks)?

Word of advice: Keep it simple, you will have opportunities to iterate and expand your game later, but done is better than perfect, and you have a deadline! Your initial goal is to get started with something that you can do.

As your understanding of the game logic deepens, return to step 2 and adjust your mock-up, removing unnecessary elements and adding new ones.

(Write your own game logic below, following the template format 📌)

Water Quest - Game Logic:

1. Game Start:

- What happens when the game first loads or starts?

When the game loads, the Starting Page appears with the charity: water logo, game title, instructions, and a "Start Game" button

- Are any elements placed on the screen? (e.g., items, score, timer)

Clicking "Start Game" transitions to the Gameplay Page, where the score resets to 0, the collected counter resets to 0, and the 30-second timer begins counting down. The play area (dotted/dashed border zone) is empty until drops begin appearing.

2. Player Actions:

- What can the player click, tap, move, or do?

The player uses the drill cursor to tap on drops as they appear in the play area.

- How does the game respond to those actions?

Tapping a clean water drop registers as a successful hit

Tapping a muddy drop incurs a -5 score penalty.

3. Game Logic:

- What rules or conditions should the game check for?

Drops spawn at random positions within the play area at set intervals (e.g., every 1-2 seconds). Each drop stays visible for a short window before disappearing.

- What happens when the player succeeds or fails at something?

The game checks whether the player's tap coordinates match an active drop's position. Clean drops and muddy drops appear randomly, with clean drops appearing more frequently than obstacles

4. Score/Feedback:

- How is the score updated?

Tapping a clean drop: Score increases by a set amount (+10), and the Collected counter increases by 1

Tapping a muddy drop: Score decreases (-5), and causes a brief visual flash to indicate mistake.

- What visual or audio feedback appears based on player actions?

The Score and Collected numbers update instantly on tap.. A different sound is played based on whether the drop spawns in, the player taps the clean drop, or the player taps the dirty drop.

5. Win or Lose Conditions:

- How does the game end?

The game ends when the 30-second timer reaches 0.

- What happens when the game ends (e.g., show a message, reset option)?

An end screen appears displaying the final score, the total drops collected, and a brief mission message.

6. Reset/Replay:

- Can the player restart the game? What happens on reset?



The end screen includes a "Play Again" button that resets the score, collected counter, and timer, then returns the player to an active game round. On reset, the timer resets to 30s and the score resets to 0.

Step 4: Add Branding

Great games for nonprofits carry the brand's identity throughout the experience. Your prototype should feel like it belongs to charity: water from the moment someone sees it. Refine your initial sketch by adding colors, icons, and styles that align with charity: water's brand guidelines. If you're keeping your mock-up minimal, include notes on where the brand's colors, images, links, or icons will be incorporated.

charity: water Brand Guidelines

Primary Color	#FFC700 (Signature Yellow) – used on CTAs, highlights, and icons
Secondary Color	#00A19D (Teal) – used on backgrounds and supporting elements
Typography	Clean, sans-serif. Headlines bold and impactful.
Logo	The charity: water logo and yellow jerry can are iconic assets. Use them!
Tone	Hopeful, energetic, human. Not guilt-driven.
Key Message	"100% of public donations go directly to water projects."

Branding Checklist

- ☒ Yellow (#FFC700) appears somewhere in my game UI
- ☒ The charity: water name or logo is visible on at least one screen
- ☒ A real-world impact message appears (e.g., at a milestone)
- ☒ A link or CTA to charitywater.org is included on the end screen
- ☒ The overall color palette, fonts, and tone feel consistent with the brand

Where specifically have you incorporated charity: water's brand? Describe it below:

Color palette: The signature yellow (#FFC907) shows up throughout both screens: the Start button on the landing page, the jerry can icon, and the bold outer frame on the Gameplay page. A light blue (#77A8BB) is the background color on both pages, keeping the palette consistent and recognizable as charity: water's identity.

Logo and iconography: The charity: water wordmark and jerry can icon are both visible at the top of the Starting Page which shows the organization the game represents. The jerry can also reappears conceptually through the drill mechanic as the drill ties back to how charity: water actually funds borehole drilling to access clean groundwater.

Typography: Everything utilizes the charity: water brand font proxima nova in order to adhere to brand typography.

Key message: The line "All proceeds go toward water projects!" appears in the footer of the Starting Page and reflects charity: water's real key message that 100% of public donations go to water projects.

Tone: The overall feel stays hopeful and calm with hints of optimism instead of centering the water crisis around hardship.

Step 5: Build Your Prototype

Time to build! Use one of the following tools to turn your wireframe into a real, playable prototype. You don't need a perfect game - you need a working demo.

Tool	Best For	URL
Replit	Writing your own HTML/CSS/JS with AI code help	replit.com
Lovable	Describing your game in plain English and generating code	lovable.dev
Cursor	AI-assisted coding if you prefer a local editor	cursor.com

Build Tips

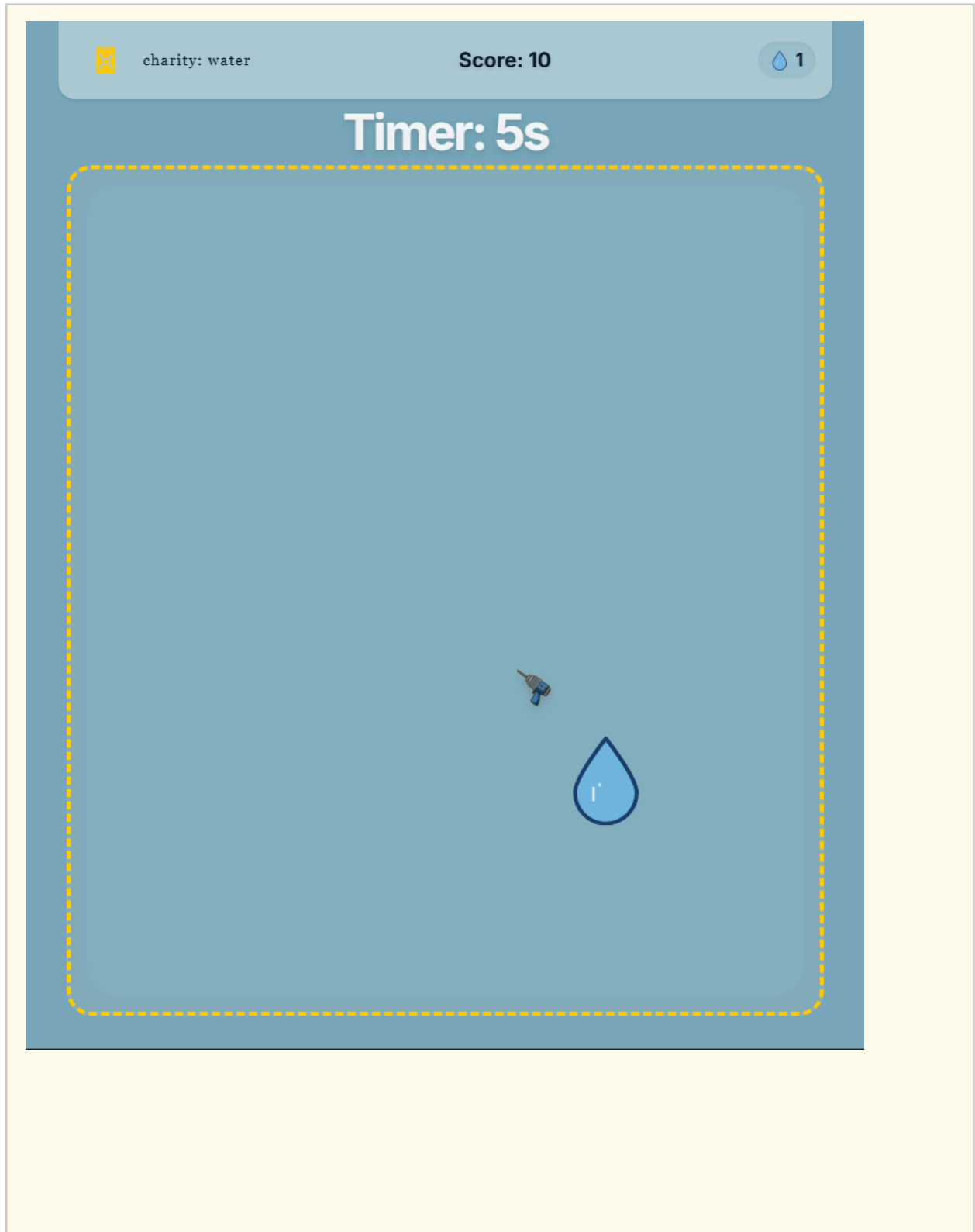
- Start from your wireframe, not a blank page. Build one screen at a time.
- Use AI to help write code. Describe what you want in plain English: "Write JavaScript that increases a score counter by 10 when I click a div."
- Keep your first version minimal. Get it working, then improve it.
- Test it yourself before submitting. Does it actually run? Can you play it?

Submit Your Prototype

Paste a **public link** to your working prototype below. Test it in incognito mode first to confirm anyone can access it.

<https://water-quest-jyu2029.replit.app/>

Take a screenshot of your running game and paste it below:



Step 6: LevelUp - Show Your Work on LinkedIn (10 pt)

Draft a short LinkedIn post about what you've learned from creating a game prototype for charity: water. You might reflect on what it felt like to design for a mission-driven organization, a challenge you overcame during the design or build process, how thinking about branding and user experience shaped your decisions, or what surprised you about turning an idea into a working prototype.

Consider adding your public game link to your post! Recruiters and potential employers love seeing posts that showcase your creativity, technical growth, and ability to do real work for real organizations.

(Paste or write your answer below 📌)

I just finished building "Water Quest," a game prototype for charity: water, where players use a drill (a reference to real borehole drilling) to collect clean water drops while avoiding contaminated ones.

This project forced me to think like a UX designer, game designer, and developer all simultaneously. I was met with a few challenges relating to branding, such as small details like hex codes and icon sizing. I also learned that there is often a lot to change once the first iteration becomes a live, playable version. Things like timing and spacing behave differently than you'd expect initially, which makes you change dozens of little aspects gradually as you polish the game.

I really enjoyed the interdisciplinary nature of this project, along with the chance to design for such a wonderful organization and think through how branding and user experience come together. Check out the working prototype below.

<https://water-quest-jyu2029.replit.app/>

– Save and submit your work!

Great work completing this Project! To submit your work, download / export this document as a PDF and then upload it to the Project submission page on HQ. You can find the option to download as a PDF from the File menu in the upper-left corner of the Google Doc interface.